

Use-Case Flow Specification

Problem Statement #53 – Freelance Content Creator Escrow Platform

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SECTION:F

Use Case: UC-05 – Approve Draft Deliverable

Primary Actor: Client Sponsor

Secondary Actors: Content Creator (receives payment), Payment Gateway (moves funds)

Preconditions

- A milestone exists for the contract with a locked payment amount.
- The Content Creator has submitted a draft deliverable for that milestone (UC-02).
- The system has watermarked the draft (UC-03) and it is visible to the Client Sponsor.

Postconditions

- Success: The milestone status is 'Approved' and the payment amount has been released from escrow into the Content Creator's balance.
- Failure/Alternate: The milestone status is 'Rejected', no funds are released, and the Content Creator is notified with the sponsor's comments.

Main Success Scenario

1. Client Sponsor opens the submitted milestone and views the watermarked draft deliverable.
2. System displays the draft along with Approve and Reject options and a comment field.
3. Client Sponsor reviews the draft and selects “Approve”, optionally adding a comment.
4. System validates that the milestone is still in 'Submitted for Review' status.
5. System records the approval decision with a timestamp and sponsor ID (this triggers the included use case, Release Milestone Payment – UC-06).
6. System instructs the Payment Gateway to release the locked milestone amount from escrow.
7. System credits the released amount to the Content Creator's balance and updates the milestone status to 'Approved'.
8. System notifies both the Client Sponsor and the Content Creator that the milestone is complete and paid.
9. Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow – A1: Sponsor Rejects the Draft

- A1.1 (branches after Step 3): Instead of Approve, Client Sponsor selects “Reject” and enters a required comment explaining the issue.
- A1.2: System records the rejection decision with a timestamp; no payment release is triggered and no funds leave escrow.
- A1.3: System sets the milestone status to 'Rejected' and notifies the Content Creator with the sponsor's comment.
- A1.4: Content Creator may submit a revised draft against the same milestone, re-entering the flow at UC-02 (Submit Draft Deliverable).
- A1.5: Use case ends without payment release.